

LiveQueue: LA Domination Plan

Own live-music song-request and tipping. Two brothers, tiny budget, LA first. Every tactic below survived an adversarial evidence panel.

WHY NOW: Nobody has won this. The claimed leader NoSongRequests advertises 21,000 performers but shows about 18 App Store ratings. Tiply, the closest clone, has 4. Thirty-plus lookalikes, near-zero real traction anywhere. The space is wide open.

1. THE WEDGE

LiveQueue is the only live song-request and tip tool where you keep 100 percent and the money lands straight in your own Venmo, because we never touch it, while Tiply and the rest route your tips through a processor that skims a cut and can freeze your funds.

2. FIRST 30 DAYS: SEED ONE CORRIDOR

Do not spread across LA. Pick the Silver Lake and Echo Park strip. It has dense, walkable live-music rooms.

Lock 3 anchor rooms:

- Silverlake Lounge (weekly residencies)
- The Echo / Echoplex (multi-act bills)
- The Mint (nightly rooms, singer-songwriter crowd)

Steps, week by week:

1. Isaac and Glen go in person. Do not just hand out flyers. Win the HOST or the residency act first. They are your salesperson to every act on the bill.
2. Give the host a free lifetime Pro account. Set up LiveQueue to run the whole night. One QR on every table. One the host shows from the mic between acts.
3. Onboard each act on the spot in 60 seconds. Set up their own Venmo or PayPal note code with them. Run LiveQueue live for one set so they see tips land at 0 percent in real time.
4. Coach every act on one stage line: "Request a song, scan the code, it goes straight to my Venmo."
5. Print their table tents for free. Every tent reads: "0 percent fee. Straight to your own Venmo. Get yours free at getlivequeue.com."
6. Use that night's other musicians as tomorrow's leads. Most of the crowd at these rooms also gig.
7. Show up every week until the room is saturated. Then work the next room in the SAME strip before leaving it.

Budget: about 40 dollars in table tents per room. Comped host Pro is zero marginal cost. Gas and a round of drinks.

Track two numbers per night: signups, and how many of those acts run LiveQue at their next paid gig. That second number is the real one. Cut any room that does not convert.

3. DAY 30-90: EXPAND AND REPEAT

Once the first strip runs on LiveQue by default, clone the exact playbook. Do not invent a new one.

- Add weekly residencies and cover bands as your best node. A residency act plays the same room to a fresh crowd every week, so one signup re-seeds that room for you for free. Target house bands at Harvard & Stone, neighborhood bars, and standing weekly slots.
- Recruit open-mic hosts as force multipliers. One host puts the tool in front of the whole lineup. Free co-branded QR, no fee.
- Seed LA open mics in bulk to recruit, not to perform. Work 2 to 3 nights a week in the corridor. Sign up 3 to 5 acts per night for their NEXT paid gig, then leave. Lean on 2 or 3 comped ambassadors so it is not all on the brothers. Every signup pitch leads with "0 percent and it lands in your own Venmo."
- Do NOT rebuild open-mic sign-up sheets. Booked Mic and Ajar Mic already own that. Just co-locate at the same venues they serve.
- Run a one-off busker blitz at 2 legal high-traffic spots (Venice Beach boardwalk, Santa Monica Pier). Weatherproof QR signs. Pitch: "Direct to your own Venmo, no platform can freeze or hold your money." Cash is nearly gone, so buskers need this. Do not turn it into a standing operation.

Only after the corridor is dense do you move to the next LA scene. Density is what makes a two-sided market tip. Yelp did one city for a year. Uber and DoorDash won one market first.

4. GROWTH LOOPS TO BUILD, IN ORDER

Build these into the product so it spreads by being used.

1. Fan-page badge: every fan who scans the stage QR sees a footer reading "Powered by LiveQue, 0 percent straight to your Venmo, get it free," linking to a 60-second signup, and in LA a big share of any crowd are themselves musicians. (Highest-exposure surface, build first.)
2. Live-queue peer demo: the on-screen queue visibly shows tips landing direct at 0 percent, so the other acts, the sound tech, and the booker watch the edge work in a real room.
3. Tip-confirmation invite: the instant a fan's tip auto-confirms, show "You just tipped at 0 percent, want fans to tip you the same way? Start free" with a prefilled share.
4. Musician-to-musician referral, paid in Pro months not cash: a referred act who runs a gig earns both sides free Pro time, framed as "we never touch money, so we pay you in features." (Turn this on only after acts show repeat use, since referrals fall flat without retention.)
5. Artist fan CRM: after each show, hand the act a clean, consented list of who requested and tipped, so LiveQue becomes their fan database and switching gets painful. (Ship last, only with real opt-in consent.)

5. CHANNELS AND EXACTLY WHAT TO POST

Lead every asset with the wedge first. It multiplies every other tactic, so ship it everywhere before anything else: "0 percent fee. Tips go straight to your own Venmo or PayPal. We never touch your money."

- Homepage and every ad: the wedge headline, plus a plain "read the fine print" fee table. LiveQue: 0 percent, direct. TipTune: 10 percent. Zink: 5 percent. Lime DJ: 14 to 35 dollars a month. Tiply and most others: routed through Square or Stripe, about 2.9 percent plus 30 cents skimmed per tip.
- Homepage: a 15-second clip that kills the "Venmo tips can't be verified" objection out loud. Show the note-code auto-confirm the tip and bump the song with no manual checking. This removes the exact excuse rivals use to justify their fees.
- Own the search surface: publish your own honest comparison and category pages targeting "song request app," "digital tip jar for musicians," "free tip jar no fees," "Tiply alternative," "NoSongRequests alternative," "keep 100 percent of tips." Add a "0 percent fee calculator" showing what a 10 percent cut or a 1.50-per-fan fee costs an act over a year of gigs. Buyers discover this category through comparison pages, and rivals write their own to rank. Defer buying keyword domains until a page actually ranks.
- Get added to independent editorial roundups (Gigmor-style). Send a clean fact sheet with the one line they lack: the only true 0 percent direct-to-Venmo option that also auto-verifies. Skip rival-run comparison blogs, they will never add you.
- Local press: submit to VoyageLA (a 2-minute form) and pitch Grimy Goods and LA Music Blog. Headline: "Two LA brothers built a 0 percent tool so musicians keep every dollar." Use the coverage as credibility on the site and in every room pitch. Treat it as trust, not an acquisition channel.

Keep the product itself simple. Market the speed: "Set up in 60 seconds, fans tip in 10, nothing to download." Do not bloat into an everything-app. Feature bloat trades your clearest advantage for a fight you cannot win.

6. WHAT WE ARE NOT DOING, AND WHY

- We never take a cut and never paywall the core. Requests, tipping, and the queue stay free forever at 0 percent. Pro at 4.99 a month is cosmetic and power extras only. The moment we skim, we become the thing we attack and lose the only positioning that beats 30 lookalikes. The revenue discipline IS the marketing.
- No fan cash giveaways (the Cash App Fridays idea). It works only for companies that hold the money, which is the opposite of our model, and it costs recurring cash a 0 percent passthrough cannot fund.
- No per-tip auto viral video pipeline. There is no evidence a single-transaction clip spreads, and the render cost is real work for two people.
- No paid retargeting ads as a launch plan. It is exactly what the traction leader already tells everyone to do, so it buys no advantage and clashes with the zero-extra-spend rule. Drop the free pixels now, spend nothing until an organic gig proves conversion, then test small and kill fast.
- No grinding anti-promo subreddits, Discords, songwriter unions (AFM Local 47), or Sofar Sounds sets. Low fit, low ceiling, or the no-phones rule kills the demo. The same hours buy far more at

open mics and residencies.

One cut I would keep in a lighter form: film the live tip-to-bump moment as a free byproduct of the room work you are already doing, and post it opportunistically. Zero added cost, and "watch a stranger bump my setlist for 5 dollars" is a natural clip. Just do not staff it as a content channel.

Method: 4 research bots surfaced 48 tactics. A 3-seat adversarial panel (evidence skeptic, solo-founder realist, differentiation-vs-Tiply skeptic) scored each on proof, feasibility for two people, and lasting advantage. 31 survived, 17 were cut. This plan is built only from survivors.